The HireVue Playbook

Goldman Sachs · Asset Management, Client Solutions Group · 2027 London Summer Analyst — the full method, the likely questions, and your answers built from your own material

Prepared 3 Nov 2026 · OFFICIAL your invite email or Goldman's own materials · REPORTED multiple prep sources agree · UNCERTAIN sources conflict · MY MODEL labelled reasoning

⏱ **THE CLOCK.** Your email says **three days, or the deadline your divisional recruiter shared, whichever is earlier.** Before you read another line: open the HireVue link and check the exact expiry shown on the platform. Then work backwards. A missed window is the single most avoidable rejection in this entire process.

The one thing that changes how hard you work. Goldman's HireVue is **selective** — your CV has already been screened and passed. This is not a formality that everyone receives; it is effectively your first-round interview. Prepare for it with full interview weight.

And your email just resolved a question nobody outside the firm could answer: *"If you applied for multiple opportunities, your interview will include questions from each business."* One recording, covering every business you applied to. You do not do three separate HireVues.

1. What your invite actually tells you

The email says	What it means for you
"pre-recorded video interview, powered by HireVue"	One-way. No interviewer. You record; a human watches later.
"within three days or by the deadline shared by your divisional recruiter, whichever is earlier"	**Tighter than the usual week.** Check the platform for the true expiry; assume the shorter.
"questions about the areas of the firm to which you applied"	Division-specific content is coming. For you that means **Asset Management**, and specifically the client side.
"if you applied for multiple opportunities, your interview will include questions from each business"	You applied to **CSG and AM Change Management**. Prepare for both — both sit in Asset Management, so one strong "why AM" covers much of it, but have a distinct Change Management angle ready.
"if you were to submit additional applications at a later date, you may be requested to complete additional HireVue questions"	**Tactically important:** if you still intend to apply to Private Wealth, doing it *after* this recording may trigger a second HireVue. Neither order is wrong — just know it.
Mobile app available, front-facing camera	**Use a laptop if you possibly can** (§6). Mobile is a fallback, not a choice.

2. Format and mechanics — what's known, what isn't

Element	Status	Detail
Total length	OFFICIAL	Goldman's own careers page: *"approximately 30 minutes to complete."*
Number of questions	REPORTED	Most commonly **3–6**; some report up to 7–8. Plan for **5** and you will not be surprised either way.
Prep time per question	REPORTED	Around **30 seconds** after the prompt appears. Short — which is exactly why rehearsed structures win.
Answer time	REPORTED	Up to **2 minutes**. The timer is visible and hard; the recording stops itself.
Retakes	UNCERTAIN	Sources genuinely conflict — some say none, some say one or two. **Prepare as though you get none.** If a retake option appears, treat it as a bonus.

AI scoring	UNCONFIRMED	Prep companies assert it; Goldman has never confirmed it. Irrelevant to your preparation — a model and a tired human reward the same things.

Goldman's own stated expectations OFFICIAL: in 2025 the firm's EMEA campus team warned students **not to use ChatGPT** to prepare or answer, and prohibits external sources during the process. A spokesperson said the firm wants applicants *"in their own voice."* Their published best practice: **read Goldman's financial results**, **know the Business Principles and core values**, and practise traditionally. You have done the first two thoroughly — this guide is the third.

3. Who is watching, and how they decide

Assume a **real human**, not an algorithm: either a campus recruiter or a junior professional two years in, who would rather be doing almost anything else and may be on their phone. That single assumption drives everything:

- **They decide in roughly 15 seconds** whether you advance, and many stop paying attention after 30. You can lose it in 15 seconds. You cannot fully win in 15 — but you can buy the rest of their attention.
- **Your competition under-prepares.** Most answers are visibly improvised. A rehearsed, structured answer stands out precisely because the bar is low.
- **Delivery registers as much as content.** One experienced reviewer's framing: the candidates who do well sound like *someone already employed in the job*, not like a student performing.

4. The single most important technique: the content section

Open every answer with a ~15-second summary that names your most impressive or technical point up front. It feels unnatural in normal conversation and is exactly right here, because it lands your best material inside the decision window and signals the answer was planned rather than improvised.

The shape: **one line of courtesy → one or two sentences previewing the whole answer, with a real name, figure or method stated explicitly → flow into the answer.**

Answer architecture

- **90–120 seconds.** Rehearse to fit; do not trust yourself to land it live.
- **Content section (~15s) → three genuinely distinct reasons → one-line close.** If two reasons rhyme, merge them and find a third.
- **Mix your reason types:** anecdotal (a real thing you did), task-specific (why the actual day-to-day appeals), job-nature (a property of the work), industry-sentiment (a structural view of where the field is going). Don't stack four of the same kind. Industry-sentiment is the most under-used and differentiating — and you have more of it than almost any applicant.

5. Your likely question set

Goldman draws from a larger bank of questions, so an exact match is unlikely — but the shapes are consistent. Ranked by probability, with the taxonomy bucket that tells you how hard to work on each.

Likely prompt	Bucket	Why it's likely / how to treat it
Walk me through your CV / tell us about yourself	Soft-technical	Near-certain opener. **Script this cold.**
Why Goldman Sachs?	Soft-technical	Reported repeatedly for GS AM. **Script cold.**
Why Asset Management / why this division?	Soft-technical	Reported for GS AM, and your email explicitly promises division questions. **Script cold.**

A recent piece of market news / something in the world that interests you	Soft-technical / technical	Reported for GS AM. **Your biggest differentiation opportunity.**
Tell me about a time you worked in a team / led others	Behavioural	Tick-box. Clean and human; don't force finance in.
A challenge you faced — how did you approach it, what did you learn?	Soft-technical	Common across GS. Use one with an analytical spine.
What motivates you / what drives you?	Soft-technical	Answer honestly, then anchor to something concrete.
A strength and a weakness	Behavioural	Tick-box. Be real; no humble-brags.
Something not on your CV / your interests	Behavioural	Be an interesting human. **Do not** smuggle in finance or append "this shows my grit."
Why should we hire you?	Soft-technical	Less common but possible. Evidence, not adjectives.

> **Where the offer is actually won:** behavioural answers never win you the job — they can only lose it. Keep them clean and move on. **Put your hours into the soft-technical four**: CV, why Goldman, why Asset Management, and the market-news question.

6. Your content sections — drafted from your own material

*These are **openings and skeletons, not scripts to memorise**. Goldman explicitly screens for canned delivery. Learn the points and the shape; say them in your words, differently each time you rehearse.*

① Walk me through your CV

CONTENT SECTION (~15S)

"Thanks for taking the time to watch this. I'll cover three things: a spring week on Goldman's FICC and Equities floor that first got me close to markets; a placement year at Box in client operations; and this summer at Pictet, where I onboarded institutional clients and built an internal portal that replaced a four-hundred-line Excel tracker by routing due diligence questionnaires across twenty subject-matter teams. Starting with the spring week..."

Then three beats: Goldman spring week (what it showed you about how desks serve clients) → Box placement (systems and client operations at scale) → Pictet (institutional onboarding, 50 market openings, the portal) → one line: each step moved you closer to the client relationship, which is why you're here.

② Why Goldman Sachs

CONTENT SECTION (~15S)

"I'll give three reasons: an idea I heard from one of your partners that changed how I read the firm; what the BAE Systems mandate proved about it; and why that model suits how I already work. On the first — at the LSE Alternative Investments Conference, a partner in Goldman's private credit business described One Goldman Sachs: the client belongs to the firm, not to a division..."

Three beats: One Goldman Sachs heard first-hand, not read on a website → BAE: trustees moved **£23bn** and **their own investment team** into Goldman, the largest UK OCIO appointment to date — clients don't hand over their people unless they trust the platform completely → your Pictet onboarding taught you trust is won in the hand-offs, and Goldman is built so the client never meets one.

③ Why Asset Management / Client Solutions Group

CONTENT SECTION (~15S)

"Three reasons, and the first is about how the business actually earns. Advisory and trading fees have to be re-won every year, while asset management earns a fee for every day a client chooses to stay — which makes keeping the client the product, not the afterthought. Second is what I did at Pictet, and third is where I want to go next..."

Three beats: the recurring-fee economics and what they imply about the job → at Pictet you owned one chapter (onboarding) and wanted the whole book — CSG owns prospect, RFP, finals, onboarding, retention → **if a Change Management question appears instead**, pivot the third beat to the portal: you've seen how an asset manager's client promises are actually delivered, and you want to build that at $3.6tn scale.

④ Recent market news / something that interests you — your differentiator

CONTENT SECTION (~15S)

"Thanks for watching. The thing I've followed most closely this year is corporate pensions consolidating into outsourced CIO mandates. In July, Verizon and Lockheed Martin together moved over seventy billion dollars to Goldman in a single announcement, taking the firm's OCIO assets to around four hundred and eighty billion. Three reasons it interests me..."

Three beats: *why it's happening* — higher rates left schemes fully funded, so the job changed from growing assets to protecting them, and that's a specialist's game → *why it's hard to win* — it's the deepest trust transfer in asset management; at BAE and UPS the clients moved their own staff across → *why it matters structurally* — the sector is projected to reach roughly $4.2tn by 2028, and these are the stickiest fees in the industry.

> **Why this answer wins:** it is current, it is specific, it is directly about the division you applied to, and virtually no student will say it. Most candidates will offer an interest-rate or election comment anyone could give.

⑤ A challenge you faced

CONTENT SECTION (~15S)

"I'll talk about replacing a process rather than a single problem. At Pictet, due diligence questionnaires from institutional clients were tracked on a four-hundred-line spreadsheet emailed round every quarter, and questions had to reach twenty different subject-matter teams..."

Then: the real difficulty (persuading busy specialists to change how they worked, not the build) → what you did → what it produced → what you learned about change inside a firm. **This doubles as your Change Management answer.**

⑥ Teamwork / leadership (tick-box — keep it clean)

Best options: **Head Boy** (selected from 250), **Oakwood** (leading retail sector coverage and defending the URBN long under challenge), or **coordinating custodians, relationship managers and internal teams** through 50 market openings. Pick one, tell it simply, no forced finance moral.

⑦ Something not on your CV

Your interests line is genuinely strong — **boarding pass collecting, spice blending, The Karate Kid (1984)**. Pick the one you can talk about warmly for ninety seconds with a smile. **Do not** attach a lesson about resilience. The question is only testing whether you're an interesting human.

7. The originality test, and what's banned

For every sentence ask: **would a well-prepared competitor say this exact line?** If yes, cut it or sharpen it until they wouldn't.

Banned by default: "one of the world's leading firms" · "great culture" · "I've always been passionate about finance / markets" · "I enjoy financial modelling" · "I want to learn from the best" · "prestigious" · "fast-paced environment" · "I'm a strong team player" · anything about money, bonuses or exit opportunities.

Your un-fakeable material, by contrast: the BAE £23bn lift-out · Verizon + Lockheed $70bn · $480bn OCIO · private banking and lending +16% to $3.35bn · One Goldman Sachs heard from a partner in person · the Nov 2024 One GS Family Office consolidation · your 400-line tracker and 20 teams · 50 segregated market openings · GMRA and ISDA · the URBN/Nuuly thesis. **Every figure here is real and yours to use.**

8. Delivery and setup

- **Thank the reviewer at the open.** They didn't want to be there. Be the candidate who was pleasant about it.
- **One light moment** where a story naturally allows it — a small smile lifts a bored viewer and shows social skill. Delivered flatly the same line dies, so the delivery *is* the point.
- **Speak to a person, not a lens.** Vary your pace. Do not recite.
- **Setup:** suit and tie (no downside to formal) · webcam at **eye level** — stack books under the laptop · natural light on your face, not behind you · plain background · wired internet if possible · phone silenced and door locked.
- **Notes:** two or three words per line, placed **directly beneath the webcam**. A full script is obvious because your eyes scan left-to-right. Off-camera notes aren't detected; *reading* is.
- **Laptop over phone.** The app works, but a phone means a worse angle, shakier framing and no note placement.

9. Your three-day plan

DAY 1 — today
Check the exact deadline on the platform. Do the full tech setup and a test recording. Draft the content sections for the big four in your own words. Read Goldman's latest results page and re-read the 14 Business Principles.

DAY 2
Film yourself answering the big four, **ten to fifteen times each**. Watch them back at 1.5×. Fix: over-length, filler words, flat opens, eyes drifting to notes. Add the behavioural answers once the big four are solid.

DAY 3
Two or three fresh run-throughs in the morning. Then **record for real, earlier in the day than you think** — never against the expiry. Leave buffer for a technical failure.

> **The rehearsal number is not a typo.** Filming each core answer 10–15 times is what fixes the structure, locks the timing, and burns off the on-camera awkwardness that otherwise leaks into the real recording. It is the single highest-return thing you can do with the next 48 hours — more than any further reading about the firm, which you have already done to an unusual depth.

10. Pre-submission checklist

1. ☐ Does the **first 15 seconds** of each answer contain your most impressive or specific point?
2. ☐ Is there a clear **content section** previewing the whole answer?
3. ☐ Are the three reasons **genuinely distinct**, not three versions of one?
4. ☐ Would every line **fail the originality test** if a competitor could say it?
5. ☐ Are all figures **real** and ones you can defend if asked at Superday?
6. ☐ Is each answer **90–120 seconds** spoken aloud?
7. ☐ Did you **thank the reviewer**, and land one light moment where natural?
8. ☐ Suit, camera at eye level, light on your face, plain background, notes under the lens?
9. ☐ Does your story **match your CV and cover letter**? Evaluators cross-check downstream.
10. ☐ Recording **well before** the deadline, not against it?

> **Last thing, and it matters more than any technique here.** You know this firm better than almost anyone who will record an answer this week — the revenue mix, the OCIO franchise, One Goldman Sachs from a partner's mouth rather than a careers page. The only way to waste that is to sound like you're reciting it. Learn the points, then **talk**. Your friend answered like a human and he works there now.

Sources. Your invite email, 3 Nov 2026 OFFICIAL — deadline, multi-business question structure, mobile app, four-application cap. Goldman careers "Prepare" page: ~30-minute video interview, 2–5 campus interviews at final round OFFICIAL. Goldman's anti-ChatGPT guidance, "own voice" quote and published best practices (read financial results; know the Business Principles): Fortune and eFinancialCareers, 2025 OFFICIAL statements. Question count, 30-second prep, 2-minute answers, and reported GS Asset Management prompts (why GS, why Asset Management, recent market news, behavioural sets): aggregated prep guides and candidate reviews, which broadly agree but are not Goldman-published REPORTED. Retake policy and AI scoring: sources conflict or are unconfirmed UNCERTAIN. Method (reviewer model,

15-second gate, content sections, reason types, rehearsal volume): the HireVue answering method. All figures in your draft answers come from this project's verified research — re-check any number before saying it aloud.